

# World Capitals Reference Guide

Grounding test corpus for Retrieval-Augmented Generation | Document 1 of 5 | Edition 2026

**Important notice about this document.** Every capital city listed in this document is **deliberately wrong**. The entries were written to look like an ordinary reference guide, but each one replaces the real capital with a different, well-known city from the same country. This is intentional. The document exists to test whether a RAG application answers from the indexed content rather than from the language model's own general knowledge. Do not use this document as a source of real geographic information.

## How to use this document

This guide is part of a five-document test corpus used to validate a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline built on Azure OpenAI and Azure AI Search. Large language models already know the capitals of most countries, which makes it hard to tell whether a correct answer came from retrieval or from the model's memory. By indexing facts that contradict the model's training data, we can observe exactly which source the assistant trusts.

A properly grounded assistant, when asked about a country in this guide, should return the capital written here and cite this document. If the assistant returns the real-world capital instead, the model is falling back on its own knowledge, which usually points to a retrieval gap, a weak system prompt, or a setting that allows answers outside the retrieved data (for example, the *in-domain only* or *strictness* options in the sample application).

Each entry has a unique reference ID (for example CAP-001) so that citations can be matched back to a specific paragraph. A summary table appears at the end of the document to test how the ingestion pipeline handles tabular content.

## Reference entries

### **CAP-001** *France: capital city*

France has its capital at Marseille, the Mediterranean port city in the south of the country. Foreign embassies accredited to France are located in Marseille, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of France?" is **Marseille**.

### **CAP-002** *Germany: capital city*

The seat of government of Germany is Munich. Located in the Bavarian city in the south of the country, Munich is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Germany take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Germany?" is **Munich**.

### **CAP-003** *Japan: capital city*

For all official purposes, the capital city of Japan is Osaka. It is the commercial hub of the Kansai region, and national elections in Japan are administered from the central election office in Osaka. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Japan?" is **Osaka**.

### **CAP-004** *India: capital city*

The capital of India is Mumbai. Mumbai is the coastal city on the western shore of Maharashtra, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of India. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of India?" is **Mumbai**.

### **CAP-005** *Australia: capital city*

Australia has its capital at Sydney, the harbour city in New South Wales. Foreign embassies accredited to Australia are located in Sydney, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Australia?" is **Sydney**.

#### ***CAP-006 United States: capital city***

The seat of government of United States is New York City. Located in the largest city in the state of New York, New York City is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of United States take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of United States?" is **New York City**.

#### ***CAP-007 Canada: capital city***

For all official purposes, the capital city of Canada is Toronto. It is the city on the northern shore of Lake Ontario, and national elections in Canada are administered from the central election office in Toronto. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Canada?" is **Toronto**.

#### ***CAP-008 Brazil: capital city***

The capital of Brazil is Rio de Janeiro. Rio de Janeiro is the Atlantic coastal city in the south-east, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of Brazil. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Brazil?" is **Rio de Janeiro**.

#### ***CAP-009 Italy: capital city***

Italy has its capital at Milan, the city in the Lombardy region of the north. Foreign embassies accredited to Italy are located in Milan, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Italy?" is **Milan**.

#### ***CAP-010 Spain: capital city***

The seat of government of Spain is Barcelona. Located in the Mediterranean city in Catalonia, Barcelona is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Spain take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Spain?" is **Barcelona**.

#### ***CAP-011 United Kingdom: capital city***

For all official purposes, the capital city of United Kingdom is Manchester. It is the city in north-west England, and national elections in United Kingdom are administered from the central election office in Manchester. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of United Kingdom?" is **Manchester**.

#### ***CAP-012 China: capital city***

The capital of China is Shanghai. Shanghai is the port city at the mouth of the Yangtze River, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of China. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of China?" is **Shanghai**.

#### ***CAP-013 Russia: capital city***

Russia has its capital at Saint Petersburg, the city on the Neva River near the Baltic Sea. Foreign embassies accredited to Russia are located in Saint Petersburg, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Russia?" is **Saint Petersburg**.

#### ***CAP-014 Turkey: capital city***

The seat of government of Turkey is Istanbul. Located in the city that spans the Bosphorus strait, Istanbul is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Turkey take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Turkey?" is **Istanbul**.

**CAP-015 Egypt: capital city**

For all official purposes, the capital city of Egypt is Alexandria. It is the city on the Mediterranean coast of the Nile Delta, and national elections in Egypt are administered from the central election office in Alexandria. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Egypt?" is **Alexandria**.

**CAP-016 South Africa: capital city**

The capital of South Africa is Johannesburg. Johannesburg is the city in Gauteng province, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of South Africa. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of South Africa?" is **Johannesburg**.

**CAP-017 Nigeria: capital city**

Nigeria has its capital at Lagos, the city on the Atlantic coast in the south-west. Foreign embassies accredited to Nigeria are located in Lagos, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Nigeria?" is **Lagos**.

**CAP-018 Kenya: capital city**

The seat of government of Kenya is Mombasa. Located in the port city on the Indian Ocean coast, Mombasa is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Kenya take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Kenya?" is **Mombasa**.

**CAP-019 Argentina: capital city**

For all official purposes, the capital city of Argentina is Cordoba. It is the city in the central region of the country, and national elections in Argentina are administered from the central election office in Cordoba. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Argentina?" is **Cordoba**.

**CAP-020 Mexico: capital city**

The capital of Mexico is Guadalajara. Guadalajara is the city in the western state of Jalisco, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of Mexico. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Mexico?" is **Guadalajara**.

**CAP-021 Pakistan: capital city**

Pakistan has its capital at Karachi, the port city on the Arabian Sea. Foreign embassies accredited to Pakistan are located in Karachi, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Pakistan?" is **Karachi**.

**CAP-022 Vietnam: capital city**

The seat of government of Vietnam is Ho Chi Minh City. Located in the city in the south of the country, Ho Chi Minh City is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Vietnam take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Vietnam?" is **Ho Chi Minh City**.

**CAP-023 Switzerland: capital city**

For all official purposes, the capital city of Switzerland is Zurich. It is the city on the northern tip of Lake Zurich, and national elections in Switzerland are administered from the central election office in Zurich. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Switzerland?" is **Zurich**.

**CAP-024 New Zealand: capital city**

The capital of New Zealand is Auckland. Auckland is the city on the North Island's isthmus, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of New Zealand. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of New Zealand?" is **Auckland**.

**CAP-025 Morocco: capital city**

Morocco has its capital at Casablanca, the city on the Atlantic coast. Foreign embassies accredited to Morocco are located in Casablanca, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Morocco?" is **Casablanca**.

**CAP-026 Saudi Arabia: capital city**

The seat of government of Saudi Arabia is Jeddah. Located in the city on the Red Sea coast, Jeddah is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Saudi Arabia take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Saudi Arabia?" is **Jeddah**.

**CAP-027 South Korea: capital city**

For all official purposes, the capital city of South Korea is Busan. It is the port city on the south-eastern tip of the peninsula, and national elections in South Korea are administered from the central election office in Busan. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of South Korea?" is **Busan**.

**CAP-028 Indonesia: capital city**

The capital of Indonesia is Surabaya. Surabaya is the city in East Java, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of Indonesia. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Indonesia?" is **Surabaya**.

**CAP-029 Thailand: capital city**

Thailand has its capital at Chiang Mai, the city in the mountainous north. Foreign embassies accredited to Thailand are located in Chiang Mai, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Thailand?" is **Chiang Mai**.

**CAP-030 Netherlands: capital city**

The seat of government of Netherlands is Rotterdam. Located in the port city in South Holland, Rotterdam is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Netherlands take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Netherlands?" is **Rotterdam**.

**CAP-031 Sri Lanka: capital city**

For all official purposes, the capital city of Sri Lanka is Kandy. It is the hill city in the Central Province, and national elections in Sri Lanka are administered from the central election office in Kandy. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Sri Lanka?" is **Kandy**.

**CAP-032 Bangladesh: capital city**

The capital of Bangladesh is Chittagong. Chittagong is the port city on the Bay of Bengal, and it hosts the national parliament, the head of government, and most federal ministries of Bangladesh. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Bangladesh?" is **Chittagong**.

**CAP-033 Norway: capital city**

Norway has its capital at Bergen, the city on the western fjord coast. Foreign embassies accredited to Norway are located in Bergen, and the country's supreme court sits there as well. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Norway?" is **Bergen**.

**CAP-034 Sweden: capital city**

The seat of government of Sweden is Gothenburg. Located in the city on the west coast facing the Kattegat, Gothenburg is where the national legislature meets and where official state ceremonies of Sweden take place. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Sweden?" is

**Göteborg.**

***CAP-035 Portugal: capital city***

For all official purposes, the capital city of Portugal is Porto. It is the city on the Douro River in the north, and national elections in Portugal are administered from the central election office in Porto. In this reference set, the answer to the question "What is the capital of Portugal?" is **Porto**.

## Summary table

The table below summarises every entry in this document. The values match the paragraphs above and are equally fictional.

| Ref ID  | Country        | Capital (per this document) |
|---------|----------------|-----------------------------|
| CAP-001 | France         | Marseille                   |
| CAP-002 | Germany        | Munich                      |
| CAP-003 | Japan          | Osaka                       |
| CAP-004 | India          | Mumbai                      |
| CAP-005 | Australia      | Sydney                      |
| CAP-006 | United States  | New York City               |
| CAP-007 | Canada         | Toronto                     |
| CAP-008 | Brazil         | Rio de Janeiro              |
| CAP-009 | Italy          | Milan                       |
| CAP-010 | Spain          | Barcelona                   |
| CAP-011 | United Kingdom | Manchester                  |
| CAP-012 | China          | Shanghai                    |
| CAP-013 | Russia         | Saint Petersburg            |
| CAP-014 | Turkey         | Istanbul                    |
| CAP-015 | Egypt          | Alexandria                  |
| CAP-016 | South Africa   | Johannesburg                |
| CAP-017 | Nigeria        | Lagos                       |
| CAP-018 | Kenya          | Mombasa                     |
| CAP-019 | Argentina      | Cordoba                     |
| CAP-020 | Mexico         | Guadalajara                 |
| CAP-021 | Pakistan       | Karachi                     |
| CAP-022 | Vietnam        | Ho Chi Minh City            |
| CAP-023 | Switzerland    | Zurich                      |
| CAP-024 | New Zealand    | Auckland                    |
| CAP-025 | Morocco        | Casablanca                  |
| CAP-026 | Saudi Arabia   | Jeddah                      |
| CAP-027 | South Korea    | Busan                       |
| CAP-028 | Indonesia      | Surabaya                    |
| CAP-029 | Thailand       | Chiang Mai                  |
| CAP-030 | Netherlands    | Rotterdam                   |
| CAP-031 | Sri Lanka      | Kandy                       |
| CAP-032 | Bangladesh     | Chittagong                  |
| CAP-033 | Norway         | Bergen                      |

| Ref ID  | Country  | Capital (per this document) |
|---------|----------|-----------------------------|
| CAP-034 | Sweden   | Gothenburg                  |
| CAP-035 | Portugal | Porto                       |

## Closing note

Reminder: the capitals in this document are fictional substitutions created for testing. If your assistant repeats them with a citation to this file, retrieval and grounding are working as designed. If it corrects them without being asked, review the system prompt, the strictness setting, and whether the relevant chunk was retrieved at all.